

Chest & Shoulders

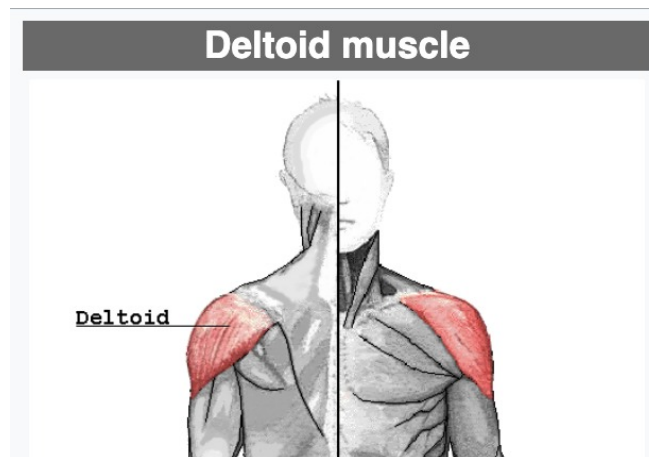
Tuesday, August 4, 2026 · Life Time Battery Park · ~45–60 min

Before you start — warm-up (5–10 min): 5 min light cardio (brisk walk, bike, or rower, easy pace, just enough to break a light sweat) → arm circles and band pull-aparts, 15–20 reps each → one light warm-up set of exercise #1 (empty bar or the lightest plates, 12–15 easy reps) before loading real weight. That's it — don't skip straight from the locker room into a working set.

Several moves here have you lying or leaning back on a bench: rise slowly between sets rather than popping straight up (Nifedipine can cause dizziness on standing). Hydrate before, during, and after.

The Target: Full Pecs & 3D Shoulders

“3D” shoulders means all three deltoid heads are developed, not just the front. The deltoid (highlighted below) wraps the whole shoulder cap in three sections: **anterior** (front, hit by pressing), **lateral** (side, the width, built by lateral raises), and **posterior** (rear, the head people skip, built by rear delt fly). Train all three or the shoulder stays flat from at least one angle.



Anatomical reference: Wikipedia, “Deltoid muscle.”

The Session

Compounds first while you're fresh (1–3), isolation after (4–6), core to finish (7). 3 sets × 8–12 reps on presses, 12–15 on isolation work — last 2 reps of each set should feel hard.

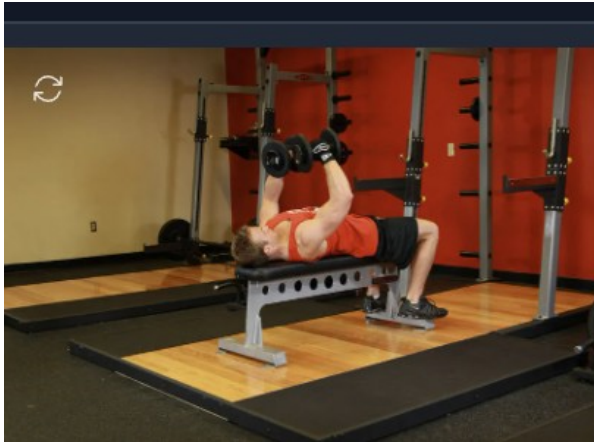


1. Incline Chest Press

UPPER PEC · 3–4 × 8–12

Machine or barbell. This is the fullness up top — the part that shows above a shirt collar. Press up and slightly back over the face, don't flare elbows past 45°.

Set 1: ____ Set 2: ____ Set 3: ____ (weight)



2. Flat / Machine Chest Press

MID PEC · 3 × 8–12

Last time: 60 / 70 / 80 lbs. Push for 70 / 80 / 90 if the top set still leaves 2 reps in the tank with good form. (Photo shows a single-dumbbell version — same flat-bench press pattern applies to the machine.)

Set 1: ____ Set 2: ____ Set 3: ____ (weight)



3. Seated Shoulder Press

FRONT + SIDE DELT · 3 × 8–12

No baseline weight yet — start conservative, log what you land on below. Press straight overhead, ribs down (don't arch the lower back to finish the rep).

Set 1: ____ Set 2: ____ Set 3: ____ (weight)

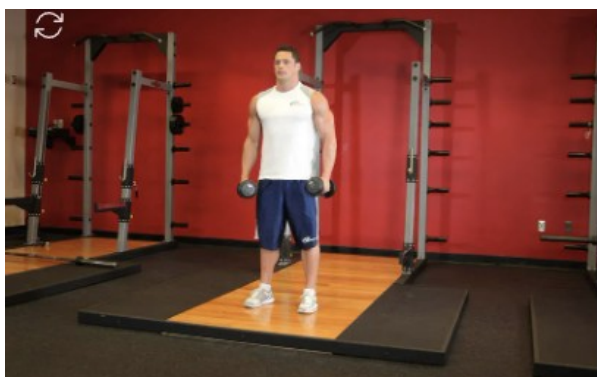


4. Dumbbell Flat Bench Fly

MID / INNER PEC · 3 × 12–15

Swapped in for the cable fly (this Life Time doesn't have a crossover station). Slight bend in the elbows throughout, feel the stretch at the bottom, squeeze at the top — don't press the weight, arc it.

Set 1: ____ Set 2: ____ Set 3: ____ (weight)



5. Lateral Raises

SIDE DELT — THE WIDTH · 3–4 × 12–15

This is the single biggest lever for the “3D” look. Raise to shoulder height, lead with the elbows not the hands, no swinging momentum from the hips.

Set 1: ____ Set 2: ____ Set 3: ____ (weight)



6. Rear Delt Fly

REAR DELT — DON'T SKIP THIS ONE · 3 × 12–15

Reverse pec-deck or cable if available, otherwise bent-over dumbbell fly as shown. The move that actually finishes the look from behind, not just from the mirror.

Set 1: ____ Set 2: ____ Set 3: ____ (weight)

FOREARM PLANK



Core — keep the shoulder-hip-ankle line straight

7. Forearm Plank

CORE · 3 sets, build past 50s

Last time: 45s / 45s / 50s. Straight line from shoulder to hip to ankle — no sagging hips, no piked butt.

Set 1: ____ Set 2: ____ Set 3: ____ (weight)

Log the actual weights above, then transfer them into workouts/logs/2026-08.md so next Tuesday's session has a real baseline to progress from.

Reference photos: Free Exercise DB (public domain). Photos show the general movement pattern — your actual equipment at Life Time may look different.